CONSULT FOR AFRICA

Duchess: what the work should cost

Fee benchmarking behind the revised position

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The revised position

N39,660,000 standard, one programme concession of N3,966,000, net N35,694,000 across six months, on 118 resourced consultant days. That is **30 per cent below the N51,039,000 first modelled**, and the reduction comes from tighter resourcing rather than from discounting the rate card.

Days fell from 171 to 118. The partner line came down from 15 days to 11, the principal from 42 to 29, and the workforce and talent input came out of scope entirely. What did not change is the clinical governance line, which at 36 days is still the largest single block, because that is where the work actually is.

Floor: N26M. Below that the team described is not the team that turns up.

What Duchess actually is

A **100-bed** purpose-built hospital at 22A Joel Ogunnaike Street, Ikeja GRA, described in the Lagos market as the city's third largest. Five operating theatres and a comprehensive critical care programme, across medicine, surgery, obstetrics and gynaecology, paediatrics, family medicine and dentistry, with recognised strength in cardiology and cardiothoracic surgery, orthopaedics, spine, maternity, neonatology, nephrology and diagnostics. Their own positioning line is "Affordable Premium Healthcare".

This matters for pricing in both directions. It is a serious institution with five theatres and critical care, so the risk surface is genuinely complex and a thin engagement would not cover it. It is also a single 100-bed site rather than a group, so a fee scaled for a multi-site tertiary system is wrong.

The external benchmark, and why it only partly applies

The most useful published figure is that a hospital of **300 beds or more** preparing for international accreditation typically spends close to **USD 250,000 fully loaded** over a ten to twelve month programme. That number is not consulting fees. It covers preparation, training, consultation, gap analysis, mock survey, documentation and operational and physical plant adjustments, plus the accrediting body's own survey fees.

Two adjustments bring it to our case. Duchess is roughly a third of that bed size. And our mandate is a risk management framework rather than full accreditation preparation, which is a narrower scope sitting inside it. Taking consulting as roughly half the loaded figure, scaling for size, and then taking the risk management share, the indicative band lands around **N20M to N40M** at an exchange rate near N1,500 to the dollar.

Be careful with this. It is a US and international analogue. No Nigeria-specific published comparator exists for this service, and Nigerian consulting firms treat fee structures as confidential, so there is no local rate card to cite. Use the band to sense-check, never to justify in a client document.

The internal comparators, which are more reliable

Engagement	Scope	Fee
Lagos specialist hospital, board governance	6 weeks, 11 board instruments, training across 3 cohorts	N5M standard, N2M net after a board partner concession
Lagos paediatric facility, transformation	5 workstreams over several months, 8 beds	N9.3M net
Healthcare group, embedded strategy office	2 to 3 senior consultants embedded, monthly	N4.5M per month, so about N27M over six months

Engagement	Scope	Fee
Healthcare group, aesthetics setup mandate	3 month sprint plus 2 month handover	N25M

Against that book, **N51M was out of line** and N35.7M sits where it should: above the group strategy office because this is deliverable-heavy rather than advisory, above the aesthetics setup because it runs six months with a five person team, and well above the board governance work because the scope is an order of magnitude larger.

How to hold it

Price is **10 per cent** of their published evaluation weighting and methodology is 40, so the fee is not what wins or loses this. Say the number once, explain that it is built from days at published rates, and stop.

Concession ladder, in this order, and not in the room today.

1. They provide the analyst and project coordinator from their own team. Saves 28 days and N3.36M, reads as generous, costs us only coordination risk. Ask for a named counterpart released three days a week in return.
2. Shorten the embedding phase from three months to two. About N1.6M. Ask for a decision this week in return.
3. Contract in two commitments, phases one and two now, phases three and four on approval of the framework. Costs nothing and mirrors their own milestone thinking.
4. Last, and only if it closes: a further five per cent, traded for a written reference and payment within five days of each milestone.

Free goodwill, spent late. No mark up on reimbursed travel. Training materials licensed in perpetuity. The dashboard hosted at no charge for the first twelve months.

Never concede. The partner days, because that is the chair of an audit and risk committee in their boardroom. The independence of the diagnostic. Payment on mobilisation.

Sources for the external figure: Mercury Advisory Group on the fully loaded cost of international accreditation, and Joint Commission International's published advisory and accreditation preparation material. Nigerian rate data: none published; Council of Registered Consultants guidance speaks only to fees being fair and reasonable.